



Business Plan — UK Edition

Prepared: 11 June 2026

1. Executive Summary

YT Transcriber is a UK-based SaaS web application that automatically fetches transcripts from YouTube videos, groups them into timestamped sentences, captures screenshots of any URLs mentioned, and exports everything as a structured Word document and ZIP archive. It is aimed at content creators, researchers, students, journalists, and productivity-focused professionals who regularly consume and reference YouTube content.

The service will operate on a subscription model via Clerk (auth + billing) and Stripe (payments), with a free trial of 3 videos followed by paid monthly tiers. The business will be registered as a UK Limited Company, fully compliant with UK GDPR, ICO requirements, and HMRC tax obligations.

Business name	YT Transcriber Ltd (proposed)
Business type	UK Private Limited Company (Ltd)
Business model	B2C SaaS — monthly subscription + free trial
Target market	Content creators, researchers, students, journalists
Primary revenue	Subscription tiers (£7–£45/mo)
Launch approach	Soft launch / public beta via website
Break-even est.	~2 paying subscribers (low fixed costs)
Year 1 target	100 paying subscribers

2. Business Structure

Recommended structure: UK Private Limited Company (Ltd)

A Ltd company is recommended over sole trader for a SaaS product. It limits personal liability, is more credible to customers and payment processors, and is more tax-efficient once profits grow.

Ltd Company vs Sole Trader — Key Differences

Choosing the right legal structure is one of the most important decisions for any UK business. The two most common options are a **UK Private Limited Company (Ltd)** and operating as a **sole trader**. The table below compares the key differences across the areas that matter most for a SaaS business like YT Transcriber.

Area	Sole Trader	Ltd Company
Liability	Unlimited personal liability. Debts or legal claims can reach your personal assets — home, savings, car.	Limited liability. Personal assets are protected. You are only liable for the value of shares held in the company.
Tax on profits	Income Tax (20–45%) + Class 4 National Insurance on all business profits. No distinction between business and personal income.	Corporation Tax on profits at 19–25%. You can extract money via a salary + dividends combination, which is typically more tax-efficient above ~£30k profit.
Taking money out	All profits belong to you directly. No formal process needed.	Pay yourself via PAYE salary and/or dividends. Dividends are taxed at lower rates than Income Tax, making this more efficient once the company is profitable.
Credibility	Perceived as smaller or informal. Some payment processors, enterprise clients, and app stores prefer not to deal with sole traders.	Seen as more professional and established. Stripe, Clerk, and corporate customers all prefer to contract with a Ltd company.
Privacy	No public register. Your details are not listed publicly unless you register for VAT.	Company name, registered address, director names, and accounts are all publicly visible on Companies House. A virtual office address can protect your home address.
Setup	Register as self-employed with HMRC. Free, takes minutes. No company registration required.	Register at Companies House (£50 online, ~24 hours). Appoint at least one director and issue at least one share.
Ongoing admin	Annual Self Assessment tax return + keep income/expense records. Minimal admin burden.	Annual accounts (Companies House + HMRC), Corporation Tax return, Confirmation Statement (£34/yr), and payroll if paying a salary. An accountant is strongly recommended.
Raising investment	Cannot issue shares. Very difficult to bring in investors or co-founders with equity.	Can issue shares to investors, co-founders, or employees (e.g. via EMI options). Essential if you plan to raise funding.

Area	Sole Trader	Ltd Company
Closing	Deregister with HMRC. Quick and cheap.	Formally dissolved (struck off) via Companies House. Slightly more involved but straightforward for a small company.
VAT	Must register when turnover exceeds £90k/year. Same threshold as Ltd.	Must register when turnover exceeds £90k/year. Same threshold as sole trader.
Best suited for	Freelancers, consultants, or very early-stage projects with minimal risk and low turnover expectations.	Any product business or SaaS that carries risk, needs payment processor credibility, aims to grow, or may seek investment. Recommended for YT Transcriber.

Why Ltd is Right for YT Transcriber

For a SaaS product handling user payments and personal data, the Ltd structure is clearly preferable from day one. **Limited personal liability** is critical when processing subscriptions. **Greater credibility** with Stripe and Clerk is essential at the payment integration stage. And the **salary + dividend model** becomes meaningfully more tax-efficient once the business is profitable. The additional admin cost (accountant ~£50–150/mo) is modest relative to the legal and financial protections gained.

Setup Costs — Ltd Company

Item	Est. Cost	Notes
Register at Companies House	£50 one-off online	Takes ~24 hours. Required before opening business bank account.
Registered UK address	~£5–15/mo	Virtual office address keeps your home address off the public register.
Business bank account	Free – £10/mo	Tide, Monzo Business, or Starling. Required for Ltd company.
Accountant	~£50–150/mo	Not legally required but strongly recommended for Ltd companies.
Bookkeeping software	~£12–30/mo	Xero, FreeAgent, or QuickBooks. Required for Making Tax Digital (MTD).

3. UK Tax & Finance

Corporation Tax

As a Ltd company, YT Transcriber will pay Corporation Tax on profits. Rates as of 2024/25:

Profit band	Rate	Notes
Up to £50,000 profit	19%	Small profits rate
£50,001 – £250,000 profit	Marginal relief	Tapered between 19% and 25%
Over £250,000 profit	25%	Main rate

VAT

Item	Rate / Threshold	Notes
Registration threshold	£90,000/year turnover	Mandatory registration above this. Voluntary registration below it is possible.
Standard rate	20%	Applies to UK B2C digital subscription sales.
Digital services — EU	Local VAT rates	Post-Brexit: must register for VAT OSS or in each EU country if selling to EU consumers.
VAT returns	Quarterly	Submitted digitally via Making Tax Digital (MTD) compatible software.

Other Financial Obligations

- **Making Tax Digital (MTD)** — HMRC requires all Ltd companies to keep digital records and submit returns via MTD-compatible software (Xero, FreeAgent, QuickBooks).
- **Annual accounts** — Filed with Companies House and HMRC each year. Micro-entity accounts are simplified if turnover is under £632k.
- **Confirmation statement** — Annual filing with Companies House confirming company details. £34/year.
- **PAYE** — Required if you pay yourself a salary through the company. Payroll software needed (many free options available).
- **Dividends** — Can be taken from profits above salary, taxed at dividend rates (lower than income tax). Requires a profitable company.

4. Legal & Compliance

UK GDPR & Data Protection

YT Transcriber collects and processes personal data (user email addresses, video history, notes, and usage data). This triggers obligations under the UK GDPR (post-Brexit version of GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018.

Requirement	Cost	Notes
ICO Registration	~£40–60/year	Required for any business processing personal data. Register at ico.org.uk.
Privacy Policy	Free to draft	Must explain what data is collected, why, how long it is kept, and user rights.
Data Processing Agreement	Free	Required with Clerk, Stripe, and any other processor handling user data.
Lawful basis for processing	N/A	Subscription = contractual necessity. Marketing = consent. Must be documented.
Right to erasure	N/A	Users can request deletion of their account and all associated data.
Data breach procedure	N/A	Must notify ICO within 72 hours of a breach affecting personal data.

Required Legal Documents

Document	Key Requirements
Terms of Service	Subscriptions, refunds, acceptable use, account termination, liability limits.
Privacy Policy	UK GDPR compliant. What data is collected, retention periods, user rights.
Cookie Policy	Required for any analytics or tracking cookies. Must allow opt-out.
Refund Policy	UK Consumer Rights Act 2015: right to refund for faulty digital services.
Cancellation Policy	Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013: 14-day cooling-off on digital subscriptions.
Acceptable Use Policy	Prevent misuse of the platform for bulk scraping or commercial resale of transcripts.

Note: Legal document templates are available from Rocket Lawyer UK, LawDepot, or a UK solicitor. Budget ~£200–500 for professionally reviewed documents at launch.

Subscription Law (UK)

- **Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013** — Customers have a 14-day right to cancel a subscription from sign-up. The free trial structure mitigates this — card is charged only after the trial ends.
- **CMA Subscription Guidance (2024)** — The Competition and Markets Authority issued new guidance requiring: clear pricing before sign-up, easy cancellation, and reminders before free trials convert to paid.

- **Auto-renewal disclosure** — Must clearly state that subscriptions auto-renew and how to cancel. Clerk's billing portal handles the cancellation mechanism.
- **Refund on cancellation** — No legal requirement to pro-rata refund monthly subscriptions, but best practice to do so or offer a grace period.

5. Domains & Infrastructure

Domain Availability (checked 11 June 2026)

Domain	Status	Notes
yttranscriber.com	TAKEN	Registered Oct 2025, expires Oct 2026. Likely squatter — monitor for expiry.
yttranscriber.co.uk	AVAILABLE	Recommended primary UK domain. Register immediately.
yttranscriber.io	AVAILABLE	Recommended for tech/SaaS audience. Register now.
yttranscriber.app	AVAILABLE	Good for app positioning. Register now.
tubascript.com	AVAILABLE	Alternative brand option — clean across .com, .co.uk.
tubascript.co.uk	AVAILABLE	Pair with tubascript.com if pivoting to that name.
transcribr.com	TAKEN	On Afternic marketplace — available to buy, price unknown.
ytscript.com	TAKEN	Registered until 2034.
vidscript.com	TAKEN	On Epik marketplace — available to buy, price unknown.
vidscript.io	AVAILABLE	Alternative if rebranding.

Recommendation: Register yttranscriber.co.uk, yttranscriber.io, and yttranscriber.app now (~£25–40 total/year). Monitor yttranscriber.com for expiry in October 2026.

Infrastructure Requirements

Item	Est. Cost	Notes
Web hosting (VPS)	~£15–25/mo	Hetzner CX22, DigitalOcean Basic, or AWS Lightsail. Single Docker container.
Domain registration	~£25–40/year	3 domains: .co.uk (~£8), .io (~£25), .app (~£12) per year approx.
SSL certificate	Free	Let's Encrypt via Certbot. Auto-renews every 90 days.
Clerk (auth + billing)	£0–20/mo	Free up to 50k MAU. Pro plan at scale.
Stripe (via Clerk)	2.1% per txn	Clerk 0.7% + Stripe ~1.4%. No monthly fee.
Transactional email	Free–£10/mo	Clerk handles auth emails. Brevo/Mailchimp for marketing.
Uptime monitoring	Free	UptimeRobot free tier — alerts if site goes down.
Backups	~£2–5/mo	Automated daily backups of user data and output files.
Claude API (AI chapters)	~£0.01/use	Haiku model. Only charged when AI chapter feature is used.

6. Product & Market

Product Summary

YT Transcriber is a web-based tool that turns any YouTube video into a structured, readable document in seconds. Unlike raw YouTube captions, it groups content into proper sentences, captures timestamps, screenshots any URLs mentioned in the video, and exports everything in a professional Word document and ZIP archive.

Key Features (current & planned)

Feature	Status	Description
Timestamped transcript	Live	Sentences grouped with clickable timestamps that seek the YouTube player.
URL screenshots	Live	Playwright captures screenshots of any URLs mentioned in the transcript.
ZIP export	Live	Download transcript (.docx), notes, links, and screenshots in one ZIP.
5 colour themes	Live	Dark, Light, Ocean, Forest, Sunset — persisted via localStorage.
Notes panel	Live	Per-video notes saved to the server.
Transcript search	Live	Filter transcript in real time.
Clerk auth + billing	Planned	Email login, subscription tiers, free trial.
Collections / folders	Planned	Organise saved videos into named collections.
Share links	Planned	Share a read-only transcript with anyone via a link.
AI chapter markers	Planned	Claude AI automatically generates chapter markers from the transcript.
Scheduled transcription	Planned	Watch a channel or playlist; auto-transcribe new videos.
Transcript correction	Planned	Edit and correct transcript text inline.

Target Market

Segment	Priority	Use Case
Content creators	High	Use transcripts for repurposing YouTube content into blogs, newsletters, social posts.
Researchers / academics	High	Extract references, quotes, and cited URLs from educational YouTube content.
Students	Medium	Note-taking from lecture recordings and educational channels.
Journalists	Medium	Transcribe interviews, press conferences, and source videos.

Segment	Priority	Use Case
Productivity users	Medium	General knowledge workers who consume and reference YouTube content.
Businesses	Future	Team workspaces — planned for Enterprise tier.

Competitor Landscape

Product	Pricing	Notes vs YT Transcriber
YouTube (built-in)	Free	Raw captions only. No export, no screenshots, no structure.
Tactiq	Free / £8+	Chrome extension only. No Word export, no URL screenshots.
Otter.ai	Free / £8+	Audio recording focus. Not YouTube-specific.
Descript	\$12+	Full video editor. Heavy and expensive for transcript-only use.
NotegPT / Scribe	Free / paid	Basic transcript extraction. Limited export options.
YT Transcriber	£7–£45/mo	USP: screenshots of URLs, structured Word export, collections, AI chapters.

7. Revenue Model & Pricing

Revenue is generated entirely through monthly subscriptions managed via Clerk Billing (powered by Stripe). A free trial of 3 videos is available to all new users — card required upfront, one-time only. Refer to the Tier Model Proposal document for full feature-by-feature breakdowns of each model.

Recommended tier model (Model C — working names):

Tier	Price	Credits	Notes
Explorer	Free trial	3 videos	Full Pro features during trial. Card required. One-time only.
Creator	£7/mo	15 vids/mo	Core transcript features. No screenshots in ZIP, no search.
Studio	£19/mo	60 vids/mo	All features. Intended sweet spot for most paying users.
Enterprise	£45/mo	Unlimited	Everything + team workspace. Future B2B expansion.

Blended ARPU estimate: £23.10/mo (20% Creator, 55% Studio, 25% Enterprise). Break-even: approximately 2 paying subscribers against fixed monthly costs.

Revenue Projections (Model C)

Subscribers	Monthly Revenue	Monthly Costs	Net Profit	Margin
10	£231	£30	£201	87%
25	£578	£38	£539	93%
50	£1,155	£52	£1,103	96%
100	£2,310	£79	£2,231	97%
250	£5,775	£159	£5,616	97%
500	£11,550	£293	£11,257	97%
1000	£23,100	£585	£22,515	97%

8. Marketing & Growth

Brand & Online Presence

- **Logo** — Created ✓. Full banner (600×120), retina (1200×240), square icon (256×256) in JPEG.
- **Colour palette** — Dark #0f0f0f, Red accent #E53935, Light text #e8e8e8, Muted #888.
- **Domain** — Register yttranscriber.co.uk, .io, .app immediately.
- **Social handles** — Claim @yttranscriber on X (Twitter), LinkedIn, YouTube, and TikTok before launch.
- **Google Search Console** — Verify domain ownership and submit sitemap at launch.
- **Google Analytics / Plausible** — Privacy-friendly analytics. Plausible is GDPR-compliant by default.

Launch Channels

Channel	Priority	Notes
Product Hunt	High	Launch on Product Hunt for initial spike. Target Featured status.
Reddit	High	Post in r/productivity, r/YoutubeCreators, r/artificial, r/SideProject.
Hacker News (Show HN)	Medium	Show HN post — good for technical early adopters.
YouTube SEO	High	Target: 'YouTube transcript tool', 'download YouTube transcript', 'YouTube to Word'.
Content marketing	Medium	Blog posts: 'How to transcribe YouTube videos', 'Best YouTube transcript tools 2026'.
X / Twitter	Medium	Share launch updates, feature releases, use-case demos.
LinkedIn	Medium	Target professional users, content marketers, researchers.

9. Action Checklist

Items to complete before and at launch, grouped by category.

Business Setup

■	Register Ltd company at Companies House (£50)
■	Set up virtual registered office address
■	Open business bank account (Tide / Starling / Monzo Business)
■	Engage accountant or set up bookkeeping software (Xero / FreeAgent)
■	Register with ICO for data protection (~£40–60/year)

Domains & Hosting

■	Register yttranscriber.co.uk
■	Register yttranscriber.io
■	Register yttranscriber.app
■	Set up VPS hosting (Hetzner / DigitalOcean / AWS)
■	Configure SSL certificate (Let's Encrypt)
■	Set up automated daily backups
■	Set up uptime monitoring (UptimeRobot)

Legal Documents

■	Draft Terms of Service
■	Draft Privacy Policy (UK GDPR compliant)
■	Draft Cookie Policy
■	Draft Refund & Cancellation Policy
■	Draft Acceptable Use Policy
■	Have legal documents reviewed by UK solicitor

Product

■	Integrate Clerk authentication
■	Configure Clerk subscription tiers and free trial
■	Connect Stripe account to Clerk
■	Implement feature gating by plan
■	Build collections / folders feature
■	Build share links feature
■	Final UI polish and mobile responsiveness

■	Set up transactional email (Clerk + Brevo)
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Launch

■	Finalise pricing and tier names
■	Claim social media handles (@yttranscriber)
■	Submit sitemap to Google Search Console
■	Set up analytics (Plausible / GA4)
■	Prepare Product Hunt launch assets
■	Soft launch to test users / beta group
■	Public launch